

Review Report of manuscript: BLC-2025-08-157 (IET Blockchain Wiley)
received 27/7/2026

Paper title: Blockchain Technologies and Corporate Governance Reformation: An Agency Theory Perspective

Final decision: **Accept with Major Revision**

Main Problems/ Criticism:

1-I'm not aware of the reason that postponed the paper in the system all that long (The paper submitted 10/2025, while the review search was conducted 5/2025; I received the review invitation only in 24/7/2026, accepted it in 27/7/2026). This does not work out for a review/survey papers (14 months up till now since the survey was conducted) in a rapidly evolving field like blockchains. The paper contains only 4 references in 2025, ~7 in 2024, and naturally none from 2026. **If this is not due to the authors, I believe they deserve a chance to update their manuscript with newer references and/or results**; hence, this review is kind of quick to save them the time and since it will be repeated according to new results. - A simple systematic way to update the review, in addition to updating the search, is to check the new citations for your references.

(the existence of many new references is one of the reasons behind the accept; it is a drawback and advantage at the same time because it means the research thread is rich and there is a room for more)

2-I believe the paper is better described as a “***Systematic Review***” than a “Review”; since it is a systematic one, please correct the numbers after removing the repetition in references. Given that said, the paper does not include any DAO governance related papers (kind of skips all technical or related to the science of blockchains papers); here I meant the science as a science, but a review paper should also searches the SBC conference that gathers the most important blockchain papers around the year. To be honest, **most of the discussion section is like a long essay**; I did not find real categorization of the research threads in this area or summarization of the gathered papers.

Newer & Broader Survey:

- imenez-Castillo, L. (2026). Corporate Governance and Blockchain. In: Sarkis, J. (eds) The Palgrave Handbook of Blockchain Technology for Business. Palgrave Macmillan, Cham. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-76014-3_5-1
- Zheng, Xx., Liu, Cy. (2026). A Research on Improvement of Blockchain-Based Corporate Governance. In: Deng, DJ., Chen, JC. (eds) Smart Grid and Internet of Things. SGIoT 2024. Lecture Notes of the Institute for Computer Sciences, Social Informatics

and Telecommunications Engineering, vol 633. Springer, Cham.

https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-93825-2_18

- Motea, M., Oba, P. Who governs the ledger: rethinking blockchain governance through democratic innovation. *Humanit Soc Sci Commun* **13**, 770 (2026).
<https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-026-06980-z>
- Juan F Prados-Castillo, Eva R. Porras, Samuel Ribeiro-Navarrete, Jose Manuel Guaita Martinez. Blockchain technology to boost corporate reputation in the context of environmental, social and governance standards, March 2026, *The Journal of Risk Finance* 27(3):392-415, DOI: 10.1108/JRF-07-2025-0297
- Sofia Alvarez, “Blockchain Technology and Artificial Intelligence in Corporate Governance: A Comparative Analysis of Regulatory Responses and Fiduciary Implications Across Emerging and Developed Markets”, *International and Comparative Corporate Law Journal*, Vol(17) no.3 (2025), <https://icclj.com/index.php/j/issue/view/7>
- <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/blockchain/articles/10.3389/fbloc.2025.1654633/full>
- https://www.researchgate.net/publication/314892724_Decentralized_Blockchain_Technology_and_the_Rise_of_Lex_Cryptographia
- Check more on the direction of DAO voting challenges and risks, the imbalance of power you mentioned in the first page and ignored in the rest of the paper.

Writing Comments: (more detailed inside the manuscript)

- 1- Since this is a blockchain journal, I suggest things that not all readers are familiar with like corporate governance, Agency Theory, stewardship ,...etc (in general, problem definition comes first; also, the fact that the paper is not just about DAOs). Then proceed to explain why blockchain features/characteristics fit here in addition to DAOs in general.
- 2- Define abbreviations and cite things like Delaware and Nasdaq.
- 3- Many references are repeated, especially those of a & b are just the same single reference; **this affected the numbers counted in the tables** (in Table1 : only 4 in 2025, less than 10 references in the paper are in the year 2024 6-7).